MIL-T-46755B
30 September 1987
SUPERSEDING
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4 September 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TIRES, PNEUMATIC AND TIRES, SEMIPNEUMATIC: INSTALLED ON VEHICLES, PREPARATION FOR STORAGE OF

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the preparation for storage of pneumatic and semipneumatic tires installed on vehicles, using thin plastic film (polyethylene) bags, and includes criteria for fabrication and installation of the bags.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Tank-Automotive Command, ATTN: AMSTA-GDS, Warren, MI 48397-5000, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document, or by letter.

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SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL

L-P-378	- Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
T-R-571	- Rope, Cotton, or Cotton and Polyester.
PPP-T-60	- Tape: Packaging, Waterproof.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-P-3420	- Packaging Materials, Volatile Corrosion Inhibitor Treated, Opaque.
MIL-I-22110	- Inhibitors, Corrosion, Volatile, Crystalline Powder.

STANDARDS
MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by the contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein and in referenced specifications and standards (see 4.4, 4.5, 6.3, and 6.4).

* 3.1.1 Recycled, virgin, and reclaimed materials. There are no requirements for the exclusive use of virgin materials; however, all materials shall be new and unused. The use of recycled or reclaimed (recovered) materials is acceptable provided that all other requirements of this specification are met (see 6.4.1).

3.2 Preservation of tires during storage. Preservation of tires during storage, except for controlled humidity and warehouse storage, shall be as specified in 3.2.1 or 3.2.2 as applicable.

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3.2.1 Tires manufactured from natural or synthetic compounds. Installed pneumatic and semipneumatic tires manufactured from natural or synthetic compounds or a combination thereof shall be preserved during storage by enclosing the tire and wheel assemblies within protective polyethylene bags as specified herein.

3.2.2 Tires manufactured with anti-ozonant compounds. Tires identified as manufactured with "OZ" compounds (see figure 1) do not require additional protection. (Tires manufactured with anti-ozonants compounded into tread and side-wall stocks have inherent protection from environmental deterioration.)

3.3 Fabrication of bags. Bags shall be fabricated from polyethylene conforming to type I, class 1, grade optional, finish 2 of L-P-378. Polyethylene shall be 0.006 inch thick, color black (opaque), and may be fabricated from sheet or tube stock (see 4.3.3 and 4.5).

3.3.1 Heat-sealed seams. Heat-sealed seams of bags shall conform to L-P-378, except that bags shall be seamed with not less than 1/8-inch flat heat seals (see 4.3.3 and 4.5).

3.4 Design of bags (see 4.5).

3.4.1 Basic design. The basic design of bags shall be rectangular or square in shape and have one end or side opening, except when vehicle design characteristics require special bags (see 3.4.2). Bags shall be of sufficient size to completely enclose the tire and wheel assemblies and be secured around the axle (see figure 2).

3.4.2 Special designs. When peculiarities of vehicle design prevent the use of basic design bags (see 3.4.1), special designs shall be provided (see figure 3). Special designs shall be in accordance with the following criteria:

a. To fully enclose each single and dual tire and wheel assembly.
b. To provide the most economical utilization of material per bag.
c. To prevent direct entry of free water, snow, and solid contaminants into the enclosed area.
d. To provide escape of condensed moisture (see 3.7).

3.4.3 Bag sizes, basic design (see 4.5).

3.4.3.1 Standard bag sizes. The standard bag sizes shall be in accordance with table I for the applicable installed tire size and wheels indicated.

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TABLE I. Standard bag sizes.

Tire size	Wheels (see figures 1 and 4)	Bag size (inches)	
		Width	Length
6.00 x 16	Single	46	43
	Dual	None	None
7.00 x 16	Single	48	45
	Dual	None	None
9.00 x 16	Single	56	53
	Dual	None	None
9.00 x 20	Single	65-1/2	60-1/2
	Dual	65-1/2	72-1/2
11.00 x 20	Single	67	62
	Dual	67	76
14.00 x 20	Single	76-1/2	70
	Dual	76-1/2	86
14.00 x 24	Single	87	78
	Dual	87	96-1/2

3.4.3.2 Nonstandard bag sizes. For tire sizes not listed in table I, the bag size shall be calculated in accordance with the formulas specified in table II.

TABLE II. Nonstandard bag sizes.

Wheels	Inside width of bag	Inside length of bag
Single (see figure 4)	Width = 1.5708 times diameter of the tire plus 1 inch. (W = 1.5708 x D + 1).	Length = diameter of tire plus width of tire + 8 inches. (L = D + W + 8).
Dual (see figure 1)	Width = diameter of tire plus width of two tires plus void (V) between the two tires plus 8 inches. (W = D + 2W + V + 8).	Length = diameter of tire plus width of tire + 8 inches. (L = D + W + 8).

3.5 Preparations prior to placing bags over tire and wheel assemblies.

3.5.1 Slack allowance. Vehicles shall be raised for installation of bags. Care shall be exercised to assure that sufficient slackness is left in the bottom of bags to prevent tires from stretching and rupturing bags when vehicles are lowered to the ground. Bags shall be positioned in a manner

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which will prevent obstruction of drain holes when bags contact the ground surface. If enclosed tire and wheel assemblies are to be stored on gravel, turf, or unpaved areas, a piece of fiberboard or other suitable material of sufficient size shall be placed on the ground surface under bags to prevent rupturing of bags (see 4.5).

3.5.2 Cleaning. Bags and tire and wheel assemblies shall be cleaned in accordance with process C-1 of MIL-P-116. Cleaning shall include the removal of all foreign objects imbedded or lodged in tire treads or between dual wheels. Tires shall be thoroughly dried in accordance with MIL-P-116 (see 4.5).

3.6 Installation of bags. Bags shall be placed over tire and wheel assemblies and positioned in accordance with figure 2. Excess material at bag openings shall be folded and formed to the contour of, and against the axle assembly. Bags shall then be secured to the axle assembly using rope conforming to class 2, size (circumference) 5/8 inch, of T-R-571. Corners of bags shall be folded against installed bags and secured in that position with tape conforming to class 1 of PPP-T-60 (see 4.5).

3.7 Drain holes. Two drain holes 1/4 inch in diameter 2 inches apart shall be provided in each bag. Drain holes shall be positioned at the lowest point of the installed bag (see figure 2). For dual-wheel application, drain holes shall be positioned in approximate alignment with the void between wheels (see 4.5 and figure 1).

3.8 Volatile corrosion inhibitor (VCI) application. Crystalline VCI or treated carrier VCI shall be used within each bag (see 4.5).

3.8.1 Crystalline VCI. When used, crystalline VCI shall conform to type I of MIL-I-22110. Twenty grams shall be blown into the bag by any suitable means.

3.8.2 Treated carrier VCI. When used, treated carrier VCI shall conform to type I, class 2, style B of MIL-P-3420. One strip, 12 inches wide and length equal to the circumference of the tire plus 2 inches, shall be placed around the circumference of the tire with the VCI side out, per bag, and shall be secured in place with tape conforming to class 3 of PPP-T-60.

3.9 Marking. In addition to any special marking requirements, bags shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 (see 4.5).

3.9.1 Special marking. Bags shall have the following information stenciled in characters not less than 1/2 inch high, color white, using Flexo Ink No. 1 (see 6.3) or equal:

Date bag was fabricated.
(NOTE: To be marked by the fabricator.)
Date bag was installed.
(NOTE: To be marked by the installing activity.)

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3.9.2 Location of marking, basic design. Location of marking shall be 6 ± 2 inches from the heat-sealed end of bag and within 6 inches of the center of bag when measured from either edge.

3.9.2.1 Location of marking, special designs. Location of marking shall be specified for each special design. Location of marking shall be such so as to be visible after installation of the bag.

* 3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be of high quality and shall be such so as to insure that the tires being preserved for storage will receive the required protection against deterioration and damage (see 4.5).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform or witness any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of section 3. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Inspection of materials and processes. The Government inspector or depot maintenance personnel, as applicable, at unscheduled intervals, shall inspect all materials and processes involved in the preparation for storage to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. Any evidence of deviation from specified requirements shall be cause for refusal by the Government to conduct further inspection until objective evidence has been provided by the contractor that corrective action has been taken.

4.3 Quality conformance inspections.

4.3.1 Sampling.

4.3.1.1 Lot formation. An inspection lot shall consist of all the tires prepared for storage during an identifiable production period, from one manufacturer, submitted at one time for acceptance.

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4.3.1.2 Sampling for examination. Samples for quality conformance examination shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.2 Examination.

4.3.2.1 Acceptable quality level. Each sample selected in accordance with 4.3.1.2 shall be examined to determine conformance to the following acceptable quality levels (AQL) on the basis of percent defective:

Classification	AQL
Major	1.0
Minor	2.5

4.3.2.2 Classification of defects. For examination purposes, defects shall be classified as listed in table III. Any item in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Category	Defect	Method of examination
Critical	None	
Major	AQL 1.0% Defective	
	Fabrication	
101	Improper materials (see 3.1).	4.4
102	Improper fabrication of bags (see 3.3).	Visual
103	Improper heat-sealed seams (see 3.3.1).	Visual
104	Improper design of bags (see 3.4).	Visual
105	Improper bag sizes (see 3.4.3).	SIE 1/
	Application	
106	Improper slack allowance (see 3.5.1).	Visual
107	Tire and wheel assemblies not properly cleaned (see 3.5.2).	Visual
108	Improper installation of bags (see 3.6).	Visual
109	Improper drain hole location (see 3.7).	Visual
110	Improper VCI application (see 3.8).	Visual
111	Faulty workmanship (see 3.10).	Visual
Minor	AQL 2.5% Defective	
	Marking	
201	Illegible marking (see 3.9).	Visual
202	Incorrect marking (see 3.9).	Visual

1/ SIE = Standard Inspection Equipment.

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4.3.3 Test. To determine conformance to 3.3 and 3.3.1, material thickness and heat-sealed seam strength shall be tested in accordance with L-P-378.

* 4.4 Materials. Conformance to 3.1 shall be determined by inspection of contractor records providing proof or certification that materials conform to requirements. Applicable records shall include drawings, specifications, design data, receiving inspection records, processing and quality control standards, vendor catalogs and certifications, industry standards, test reports, and rating data.

* 4.5 Defects. Conformance to 3.1 and 3.3 through 3.10 shall be determined by examination for the defects listed in table III. Examination shall be visual, tactile, or by measurement with SIE.

4.6 Surveillance of bagged tires. Periodic surveillance of the storage areas, where vehicles containing bagged tires are stored, shall be maintained to determine condition of bags. When bags are loosened due to severe wind storms, the bags shall be retightened at the ties. All small tears shall be sealed with tape conforming to class 1 of PPP-T-60. If severe damage occurs, the bag shall be replaced.

5. PACKAGING.

This section is not applicable to this specification.

6. NOTES

* 6.1 Intended use. The requirements specified herein are intended to provide safe storage of pneumatic and semipneumatic tires installed on vehicles.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. If responsibility for inspection shall be other than as specified (see 4.1).

* 6.3 Source of material. Flexo Ink No. 1 (see 3.9.1) may be obtained from the Society of the Plastics Industry, 1025 Connecticut Ave. N.W., Suite 409, Washington, D.C. 20036.

* 6.4 Definitions.

* 6.4.1 Recovered materials. Recovered materials means materials that have been collected or recovered from solid waste (see 6.4.2).

* 6.4.2 Solid waste. "Solid waste" means (a) any garbage, refuse, or sludge from a waste treatment plant, water supply treatment plant, or air pollution control facility; and (b) other discarded material, including solid, liquid, semisolid, or contained gaseous material resulting from

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industrial, commercial, mining, and agricultural operations, and from community activities. It does not include solid or dissolved material in domestic sewage, or solid or dissolved material in irrigation return flows or industrial discharges which are point sources subject to permits under section 402 of the Clean Water Act, (33 U.S.C. 1342 et seq.), or source, special nuclear, or byproduct material as defined by the Atomic Energy Act of 1954 (42 U.S.C. 2011 et seq.) (Source: Federal Acquisition Regulations, section 23.402).

* 6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Installed tires
Pneumatic tires
Preparation for storage
Semipneumatic tires
Tires

* 6.6 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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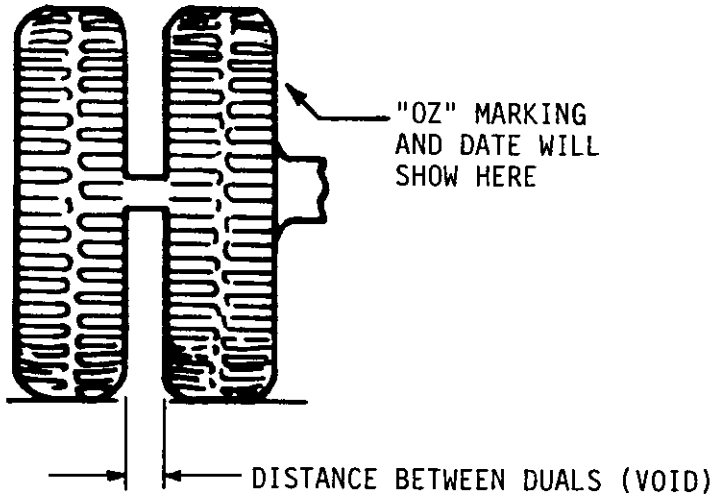


FIGURE 1. Dual wheel.

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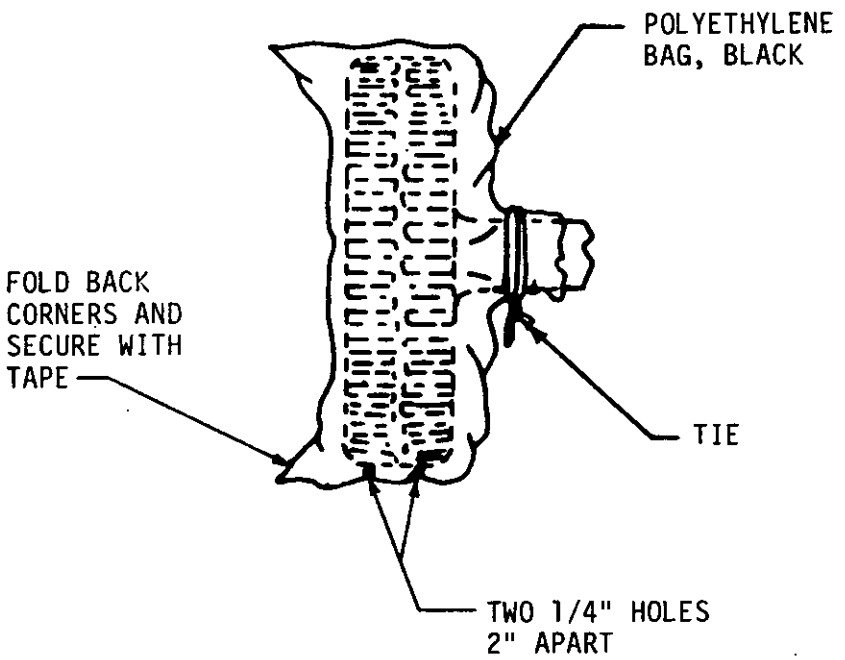


FIGURE 2. Basic design bag.

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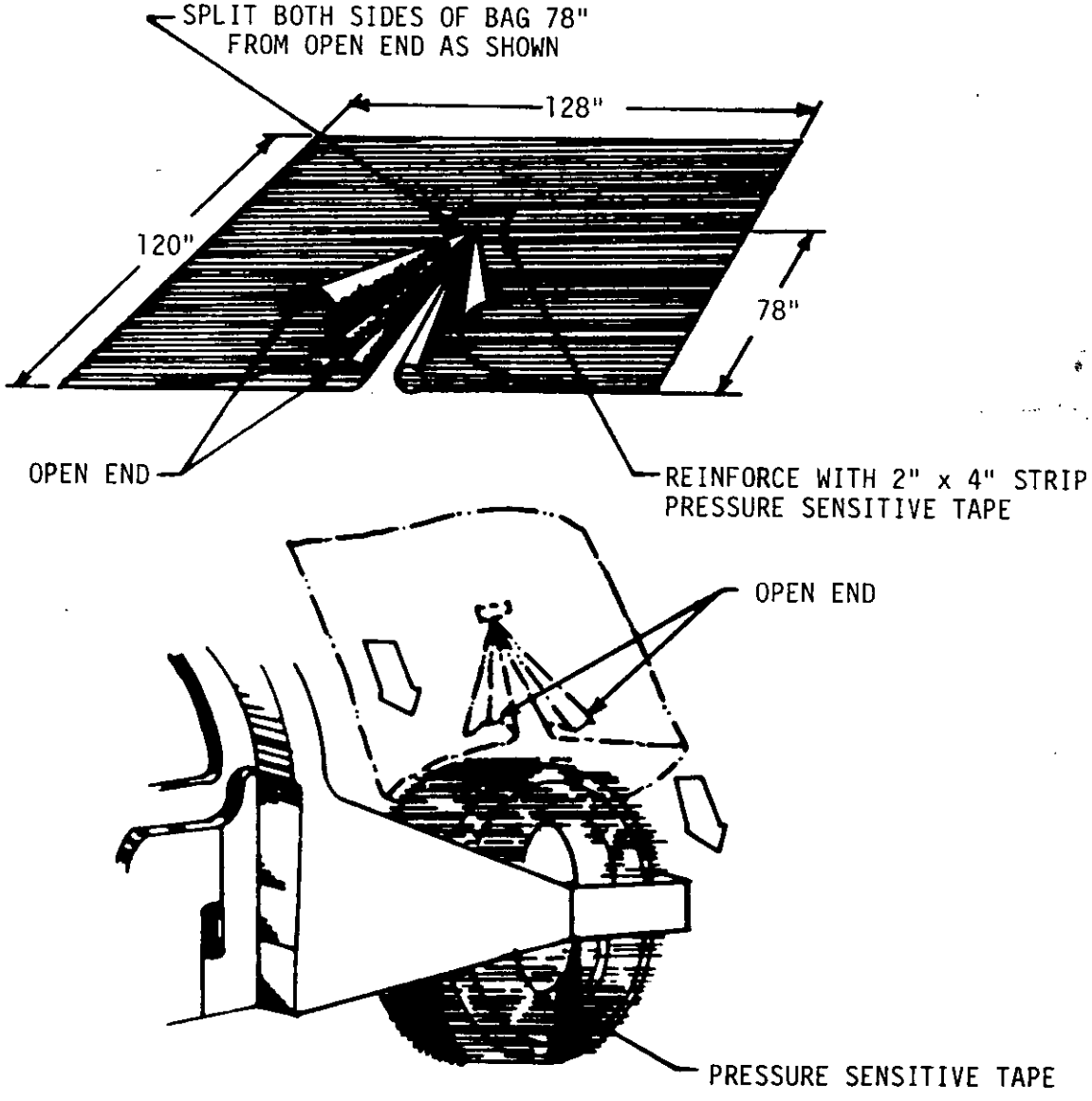


FIGURE 3. Example of special design bag.

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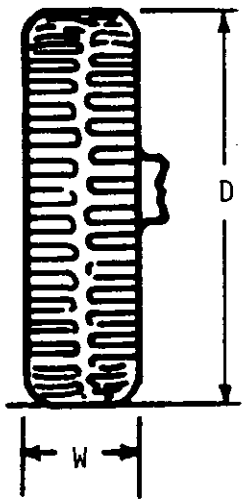


FIGURE 4. Single wheel.

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Review activity:
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User activity:
Navy - MC

Preparing activity:
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5. PROBLEM AREAS

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7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
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